

I want students to learn how to ask economic questions, use theory to reason through them, and judge what the evidence can establish. I am prepared to teach undergraduate microeconomics, undergraduate and graduate labor economics, and applied empirical methods. My teaching experience spans introductory undergraduate economics, a senior undergraduate applied course, and doctoral theory. For undergraduates, I emphasize reasoning they can use in policy debates, workplace problems, and career decisions. For doctoral students, I want to develop the theoretical understanding and empirical judgment they need to ask their own research questions.

As a teaching assistant for *Principles of Microeconomics* at USC, I learned to spark students' curiosity about economic questions and explain the underlying intuition clearly to those new to economics. In the senior undergraduate course *Economic Consulting and Applied Managerial Economics*, I organized presentations in which student teams analyzed cases such as business expansion and location choices for grocery franchises. I gave students individual guidance on how to narrow their questions, collect and analyze data, and communicate their findings. When grading reports, I gave feedback on how to strengthen both the analysis and the presentation. This experience taught me how to help students develop an economic argument into a clear, well-organized consulting report or research proposal grounded in evidence.

In Spring 2025, I served as the teaching assistant for the doctoral core course *Microeconomic Theory II* and independently delivered two lectures near the end of the semester: one on public goods and externalities, and one review lecture. For the review, I designed questions that challenged students to look beyond familiar results and think through the underlying assumptions. With the Edgeworth box, we examined Pareto-efficient allocations and competitive equilibrium as preferences and endowments changed. We also discussed judgments about distribution and how policies alter budget constraints and equilibrium outcomes. The point was to deepen students' understanding of the theory by asking which conclusions still hold when the setup changes. One student described my review sessions this way: "*He always breaks down how to actually think through a question like an economist using simple math and graphs, which makes it make way more sense.*"

Connecting intuition, models, and evidence

I bring this emphasis on reasoning beyond familiar problems to the courses I have designed. My teaching portfolio is centered on labor economics. At its core is a two-semester sequence covering the main questions and models in labor economics. Labor I starts with workers' decisions about employment, skills, and careers. Labor II examines the firms, frictions, and institutions that shape their opportunities. Studying both sides helps students explain how individual decisions translate into wages, employment, and inequality. The applied empirical methods course complements this sequence by teaching students how to choose comparisons, measure economic outcomes, and assess the assumptions behind an empirical argument. I would regularly update the readings and empirical exercises to introduce new methods through recent research in labor economics.

My special-topic courses, including organizational economics and behavioral labor, build on this foundation by guiding PhD students toward research questions of their own. I organize them into

modules so that I can develop a full-semester course or select a sequence for a half-semester offering. Each course connects basic models to current research and ends with a research memo in which students propose a question and a design to answer it. I would give feedback first on the question and then on the design, allowing students to revise before the final submission. Through this process, I aim to help the next generation of researchers formulate meaningful economic questions and sharpen their research intuition.

I would adapt this curriculum for undergraduates by adjusting the depth of the content and the balance between practical applications and research. I would emphasize graphical reasoning and guided empirical work, with assignments that ask students to interpret evidence, assess a policy or business decision, and explain their reasoning in writing or a presentation. At the PhD level, students would work through formal assumptions and identification and take greater responsibility for choosing their own questions and methods. Both groups should learn to judge whether an economic explanation fits the question and what the evidence can establish.

Developing empirical judgment and research independence

To prepare doctoral students for this independent work throughout the course, I have designed a research lab for each topic. Each lab links the lecture to a paper that I select for its economic question and empirical method. The work moves from reproducing a key result to considering how the analysis would need to change to address a question of the student's own. I would assess whether students understand how the method works and when it is appropriate to use it. Reproducing a result is a starting point; the harder task is deciding whether the method can answer the new question and explaining where it falls short.

The labs also use simulations to examine economic mechanisms. In *Organizations, Personnel, and Internal Labor Markets*, a lab on hiring and worker selection shows how changing who is hired can change average performance even when individual productivity stays the same. Students then consider what evidence would distinguish a change in workforce composition from a change in productivity, connecting an economic distinction to the design of a study.

I see this emphasis on research judgment as especially important in the age of AI. I want students to move beyond solving a given problem to asking useful questions and evaluating answers. They would need to explain the economic reasoning, justify the assumptions, and evaluate the resulting evidence. I want students to take responsibility for an argument, not simply produce an answer.

Across these courses, I want students to leave better able to ask an economic question, choose an approach to answering it, and explain their reasoning. These skills prepare undergraduates to use economics in their careers and doctoral students to become independent researchers.